



Appeal Decision

Site visit made on 1 September 2026

by **P Brennan BSc (Hons) DipTP MRTPI**

an Inspector appointed by the Secretary of State

Decision date: 23 September 2026

Appeal Ref: 6009022

Manor Farm Barns, Stratford Road, Beachampton MK19 6DT

- The appeal is made under section 78 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 (as amended) against a failure to give notice within the prescribed period of a decision on an application for planning permission.
 - The appeal is made by Mr and Mrs James and Lucinda Westcott against Buckinghamshire Council.
 - The application Ref is PL/25/5625/FA.
 - The development proposed is the demolition of two redundant agricultural buildings, conversion, and extension of existing barns to create two dwellings and the erection of two new dwellings with associated works including landscaping.
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Decision

1. The appeal is allowed and planning permission is granted for the demolition of two redundant agricultural buildings, conversion and extension of existing barns to create two dwellings and the erection of two new dwellings with associated works including landscaping at Manor Farm Barns, Beachampton MK19 6DT in accordance with the terms of the application, Ref PL/25/5625/FA, subject to the conditions in the attached schedule.

Preliminary Matters

2. The revised National Planning Policy Framework (the Framework) was published in August 2026. Main parties have been provided with the opportunity to comment on the implications of the revisions to their cases. I have taken account of the revised Framework, and any comments made, in my determination of the appeal.
3. I also have a duty under Section 66(1) of the LBCA Act to have special regard to the desirability of preserving listed buildings or their settings or any features of special architectural or historic interest which they possess. The listed building, identified in evidence, is Manor Farmhouse, which is Grade II listed.

Main Issues

4. The application was not determined by the Council within the statutorily prescribed 8-week timeframe. As such, following the submission of an appeal, it falls to me to determine whether planning permission should be granted.
5. The Council has identified, in its Statement of Case, that had it determined the proposal it would have refused the scheme due to its effect on the character and appearance of the site and surrounding area and its effect on designated and non-designated heritage assets.
6. Accordingly, in consideration of the Council's Statement of Case, officer report, and the evidence before me, I conclude that the main issues in dispute are:

- the effect of the proposed development on the character and appearance of the area, with particular regard to the proposal's design; and
- whether the proposed development would preserve or enhance the significance of the adjacent Grade II listed building and the effect on Barns 1 and 2 within the appeal site and proposed for conversion which are identified as Non-Designated Heritage Assets (NDHA's).

Reasons

Character and appearance

7. The appeal site is a complex of various vacant and in decline farm buildings that formerly comprised Manor Farm and are located at the northern end of Beachampton. The barns are a mix of traditional brick-built structures and more modern steel framed buildings. The barns are set around a concrete yard and accessed from Stratford Road. To the east of the site lies Manor Farm Business Park comprising of industrial buildings, to the south lie further agricultural buildings and to the west sits Manor Farmhouse. Aside from these adjacent uses, the site sits within open countryside. As an array of farm buildings set around a courtyard, the site makes a positive contribution to the character and appearance of the area.
8. The proposal, as detailed on the proposed layout plan (P200F) would involve the conversion of Barns 1 and 2 to form two dwellings, demolition of Barn 3 and the animal enclosure (Barn 4) and replacement with two new dwellings in a similar location and orientation. A single storey extension, located at the southern end of Barn 2 is also proposed.
9. Barns 1 and 2 are traditional brick, primarily low level, linear agricultural buildings which are arranged in a 'T' shape. The proposed extension would adjoin the south facing gable of Barn 2 and would be in the shape of a cross. The extension would have a lower, subservient roofline adjoining the existing barn which would then increase in height for the gabled ends of the extension. The main ridge of the extension would be taller than the ridge for the existing barns however, the pitch of the roof slope would be similar. Whilst the extension would have a wider gabled form than the existing barns, this would not be bulky in form and would complement the character and appearance of the barn.
10. Window openings within the extension would also be of similar proportions to those within the existing barns. The existing stone and brick facades and slate roof would be retained, and the new build element would maintain the agrarian appearance using similar materials. This would include a new profiled metal roof to Barn 2, matching and replacing the deteriorating current metal roof.
11. I acknowledge that the extension to Barn 2 would not continue the linear form of the existing Barns 1 and 2. Nonetheless, the extension would respect the simple form of the barns, would not appear overly domestic in appearance and the extension and conversion would continue to maintain a strong agrarian character. Furthermore, the barn conversions and the proposed extension would continue to sit within, extend the form of, and maintain the courtyard's appearance as a farmstead.
12. The new build proposal for Barns 3 and 4, would be provided in an 'L' shape formation on the opposite side of the courtyard. Barn 4 would be sited in a similar

location to that of the existing animal enclosures whilst Barn 3 would be sited in front of the existing steel barn which would be demolished, with the area providing private garden space for Barns 3 and 4. On this basis, the siting of the new dwellings would accord with the established layout and configuration of the historic farm courtyard that currently exists on site.

13. Barn 3 is proposed as a two-storey dwelling. This barn would also accommodate part of the accommodation for Barn 4. The new build barn would have a proposed ridge height that would be around 1.5m taller than the barn to be demolished. Whilst this would exceed the height of the existing structures proposed to be demolished on site, the ridge height would match that of the existing agricultural building to the rear of, adjacent to and outside of the appeal site. As a result, a new building, with the ridge height as proposed, would prevent unsightly views of adjacent development beyond the site boundary from within the courtyard.
14. The new build barn, for Barn 3, would appear tall and bulky in scale when compared to the relatively low profile of the older barns for conversion. Nonetheless, Barn 3 would replace a barn of similar scale. A mix of materials including horizontal and vertical cladding, glazing and a profiled metal roof would be used. Whilst this would include several types of cladding material it would be similar to that of the existing barn and more modern agricultural farm buildings seen locally. Consequently, Barn 3 would comfortably assimilate into its courtyard surroundings. Its overly simple form, whilst domestic in appearance would assist in illustrating its design as an interpretation of a modern barn conversion.
15. Barn 4 would be primarily single storey and would maintain the same linear form and low profile established by Barns 1 and 2. Barn 4 would incorporate a regular window and door configuration with a more modern and domestic appearance than the converted barns. Nonetheless, its use of similar materials to Barns 1 and 2 would ensure it would maintain the character and appearance of the historic farmyard.
16. Overall, the design of the new build dwellings, extensions and conversions would maintain and enhance the agrarian character of the former farm courtyard and would consequently accord with the rural character and appearance of the site and wider area.
17. Accordingly, the proposed development would have a positive effect on the character and appearance of the site and surrounding area. Consequently, the proposal would accord with the requirements of Policies BE2 and C1(i) of the Vale of Aylesbury Local Plan (VALP). These policies, amongst other matters, seek development proposals to respect and complement the site and its surroundings and the reuse of existing buildings that are suitable, in terms of its size, design and construction for the intended re-use without the need for complete or substantial reconstruction and development that is in keeping with the rural surroundings and where extensions are proposed, they are modest in scale, ancillary in nature, subordinate to the main building, designed with sensitivity and will enhance the character and appearance of its immediate surroundings.

Heritage assets

18. Policy BE1 of the VALP Policy requires all development to seek to conserve heritage assets in a manner appropriate to their significance, including their setting, and seek enhancement wherever possible and shall contribute to heritage

values and local distinctiveness. Proposals which affect the significance of a non-designated heritage asset should be weigh the direct and indirect impacts upon the asset and its setting.

19. HE6(1) of the Framework identifies that substantial weight be given to a heritage asset's conservation and Policy HE6(3) identifies that any harm to a designated heritage asset will be a matter of considerable importance and weight. Furthermore, Policy HE6(4) of the Framework requires development that would harm the significance of a designated heritage asset, the effect on the asset and its significance should be weighed against public benefits resulting from the proposal. The Framework Policy HE7(2) requires that where a development proposal would harm the significance of a NDHA, this should be weighed against the benefits of the proposal.

Manor Farmhouse

20. Manor Farmhouse is Grade II listed and is located adjacent to the appeal site fronting Stratford Road. The building is circa 1772 and is constructed from stone and rubble stone with timber lintels to openings, moulded brick eaves, an old tile roof and has four chimneys. The farmhouse is two storeys in height with an attic. The significance of the farmhouse relates primarily to its age, vernacular construction and design, alongside its rural setting.
21. Whilst the barns and land which are the subject of this appeal, once formed part of the farm holding in conjunction with the farmhouse, these have since been severed and are no longer used for farming purposes. The farmhouse now has a defined domestic rear garden with boundary treatment and accompanying paraphernalia. A large new dwelling has also been constructed to the south of the farmhouse. Consequently, the setting of the farmhouse has changed over time.
22. The proposal would retain and convert the adjacent barns to residential use and as outlined above, their rural character and composition would be maintained. The farmhouse still sits in its rural setting even if that no longer includes its former purpose of farming. The appeal barns would continue to contribute to the setting of Manor Farmhouse. Their sensitive conversion to residential alongside the new build elements, one of which is larger than the existing modern barn, would not harm the setting of the listed building. Whilst there is significant intervisibility between the appeal proposal and the farmhouse, the proposed changes to the site would not materially affect the rural and now domestic setting of the listed building.
23. The proposed development would therefore preserve the setting of Manor Farmhouse, and its significance would not be harmed, causing no effect.

Non-designated heritage assets

24. Planning Practice Guidance (PPG) defines a non-designated heritage asset (NDHA) as *"buildings, monuments, sites, places, areas or landscapes identified by plan-making bodies as having a degree of heritage significance meriting consideration in planning decisions, but which do not meet the criteria for designated heritage assets."*
25. Barns 1 and 2 form part of a historic farmstead and due to their historic use and group value with Manor Farm are NDHA's. As part of a farmstead group, they have some historic interest due to their location, footprint, and built form. Whilst

Barns 3 and 4 have no historic value they provide a transition between the NDHA's and the industrial buildings within Manor Farm Business Park. However, the proposed new build dwellings would equally provide the same transition. Consequently, the demolition of Barns 3 and 4, would not affect the NDHA's.

26. The proposed extension to Barn 2 would provide a small cross form of development that would breach the existing linear form of development and would be taller and wider than the existing NDHA barns. However, the extension would be located at the end of Barn 2. This would continue the linear shape adding to the length of Barn 2. A smaller link element would be lower in height than the existing barn and would clearly define the new build element from the existing barn. As a result, the location of the extension would not diminish the legibility of Barn 2 as a former agricultural building, nor would it harm the ability to understand the building's original function and evolution. Nevertheless, the extension to Barn 2 would remain agrarian in design and would maintain the courtyard pattern of development of the former farmyard.
27. The Council and Appellant have drawn my attention to a previously agreed extension to Barn 2. The proposed plan indicates via a dotted line, the location and floor area of the extension, which would be perpendicular to the existing linear barn and would protrude into the courtyard area. The Council consider that this is more acceptable due to the simple design and linear form of the extension. However, it does not naturally follow that the proposed scheme would be harmful simply by being different to that previously approved. The proposed extension to Barn 2 would continue to maintain the character and appearance of the courtyard as a former working farmyard. On this basis, I find that the proposed extension to Barn 2 would not harm the significance of the NDHA's.
28. The new barn proposed as Barn 3 would be taller than the existing barn to be demolished and would have large areas of glazing and PV panels to the roof. The barn therefore appears more domestic in appearance than a conversion of the existing barn may appear. The Council and Appellant have drawn my attention to a prior approval consent for the conversion of the existing barn to three dwellings. The Council's evidence details that the conversion limited the extent of glazing and maintained the existing agricultural character of the barn. Nonetheless, the prior approval illustrated large areas of glazing in the form of doors to two of the barn's elevations.
29. As outlined above, the increase in height proposed would ensure that the agricultural building to the rear of Barn 3, which sits outside of the appeal site, would not be visible from within the courtyard. The large amount of glazing in the form of several domestic sized windows would clearly indicate a modern purpose-built dwelling. However, the proposed barn would be clad in a variety of materials, which would be the same approach taken to the existing barn. Furthermore, the proposed barn would be honest in design and would not try to disguise its form or function and would use features associated with rural buildings. Therefore, whilst different to the heritage assets in materiality, it would not be incongruous in design to the other barns or the historic courtyard.
30. The barn would be sited forward of the existing barn's position. Nonetheless, it would have space around it and sit comfortably within its setting and would not therefore be cramped. The proposed pattern of buildings would be similar to that visible on site currently and the historic courtyard would remain clearly legible. As

a result, the proposed development of Barns 3 and 4 would not detract from the traditional farmstead.

31. Accordingly, the proposed development would not harm the setting or significance of Barns 1 and 2 as NDHA's.

Summary of effect on heritage assets

32. Overall, the proposed development would preserve the setting of Manor Farmhouse, and its significance would not be harmed, causing no effect. The proposal would also preserve and enhance the buildings and setting of Barns 1 and 2 as NDHA's, and their significance would not be harmed, also causing no effect.
33. Accordingly, the proposed development would preserve or enhance the significance of the adjacent Grade II listed building and Barns 1 and 2 within as NDHA's. Consequently, the proposal would accord with Policy BE1 of the VALP. This policy requires, amongst other matters, conservation of heritage assets appropriate to their significance.

Other Matters

34. Planning permission has previously been granted for the conversion of Barn 1 and the conversion and extension of Barn 2 to form two dwellings and the demolition of existing agricultural buildings (18/04586/APP). Prior approval was also granted for the conversion of Barn 3 into three dwellings (24/03020/COUAR). Both permissions remain extant.
35. The Council suggest that the previous approved schemes were "better" in that they were considered to respect the existing traditional farmstead arrangement and would provide five dwellings on site rather than the current four as proposed. However, whilst the previous schemes were considered to comply with the development plan, this has no material bearing on the merits of this proposal.
36. I note that several objections were received to the planning application in relation to flooding and surface water drainage. These factors are not in dispute between the main parties and were addressed in the Officer's Report, with the Council concluding that there would be no material harm in these regards and it would not have formed part of its reasons for refusing the proposal. I have also considered these matters, and am satisfied that, no substantiated evidence has been submitted that would lead me to a different view.
37. Biodiversity Net Gain (BNG) is required under a statutory framework introduced by Schedule 7A of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 (as inserted by Schedule 14 of the Environment Act 2021). Under the statutory framework for BNG, subject to some exceptions, every grant of planning permission is deemed to have been granted subject to the condition that the biodiversity gain objective is met.
38. The BNG matrix demonstrates a net gain of 0.12 habitat units on site, equivalent to a 12% net gain, thereby achieving the required 10% net gain on site. The Appellant would need to discharge the Biodiversity Gain Plan (BGP) condition, through which the 10% net gain would be secured. The final landscaping design, along with the on-site habitat units, could be set out in the BGP together with a habitat management and monitoring plan.

39. Based on the evidence before me, I am satisfied that the development could achieve the required 10% BNG and that the BGP condition, required by paragraph 13 of Schedule 7A of the TCPA 1990, is capable of being successfully discharged.

Conditions

40. The Framework states that conditions should be kept to a minimum and only imposed where they are necessary, relevant to planning and to the development to be permitted, enforceable, precise, and reasonable in all other respects. I have considered the conditions put forward by the Council against the Framework and where necessary, I have amended the wording in the interests of clarity and enforceability.
41. To ensure certainty and clarity, I have imposed the standard conditions relating to the commencement of development [1] and approved plans [2].
42. Due to its rural location and the need to secure BNG, it is necessary to impose a condition requiring the submission of a Habitat Management Monitoring Plan to protect and enhance biodiversity [3]. I have also imposed a condition requiring details of the materials to be used to ensure that the materials used are appropriate for the site and surrounding area [4].
43. To ensure that the proposed development will achieve efficiency in the use of natural resources, I have imposed a condition requiring details of measures to be included within the proposed development in accordance with Policy C3 of the VALP [5]. I have also imposed conditions requiring that the new dwellings in Barns 3 and 4 meet the requirements of Part M4(2) of Building Regulations to comply with Policy H6C of the VALP [6] and that limits water consumption in accordance with Policy I5 of the VALP [7].
44. To ensure that protected species and ecology on and adjacent to the site are protected in accordance with Policy NE1 of the VALP, it is necessary to ensure that the development is undertaken in accordance with the submitted Preliminary Ecological Appraisal and Bat Survey [8]. It is also necessary to ensure that the development is undertaken in accordance with the submitted Energy Statement to achieve greater efficiency in the use of natural resources in accordance with Policy C3 of the VALP [9].
45. A condition for the provision of the proposed parking and turning areas prior to occupation is necessary to ensure that the development does not prejudice highway safety [10]. In the interests of ensuring a high-quality development that safeguards the character and appearance of the area, I have imposed suggested conditions requiring details of proposed soft landscaping [11], boundary treatments, and hard landscaping [12]. A condition requiring the provision of the bin store in the position shown on the proposed site plan is also considered necessary to ensure that its position does not harm the adjacent heritage assets [13]. I have also imposed a replacement planting condition to ensure that any of the landscaping scheme that fails is replaced to ensure that the biodiversity and appearance of the site is maintained [14].
46. Given the proposal's design and that any changes, including further means of enclosure and further extensions under permitted development, could harm the designated and non-designated heritage assets identified and could reduce the quality of the development, it is necessary to remove permitted development rights

with respect to Classes A to E (inclusive) of Part 1, Schedule 2 [15] and Class A of Part 2, Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (as amended) [16].

47. The Council also requested conditions relating to electric vehicle charging points and cycle storage. I have not attached these conditions. The provision of electric vehicle charging points for new dwellings is required under Building Regulations and sufficient space for cycle storage is provided within the private garden space to each dwelling to accommodate such a requirement.

Conclusion

48. The Framework, at Policy H07, requires substantial weight to be given to the benefits of providing homes which will contribute towards meeting the evidenced accommodation needs of the community. This is especially pertinent in a district where the Council is not meeting its required 5-year supply of housing land at 3.73 years.
49. The proposal would result in the provision of four dwellings to which I afford substantial weight and would include the re-use of two barns identified as NDHA's. I have found that the proposed development would have a positive effect on the character and appearance of the site and surrounding area and would not cause harm to the significance of Manor Farmhouse or the adjacent NDHA's.
50. Consequently, the proposal would comply with the requirements of the VALP and the Framework as a material consideration. For the reasons given above, the appeal is allowed and planning permission has been granted subject to the conditions listed in the attached schedule.

P Brennan

INSPECTOR

Schedule of conditions

- 1) The development hereby permitted shall begin not later than 3 years from the date of this decision.
- 2) The development hereby permitted shall be carried out in accordance with the following approved plans: 2502_P_001 - Location Plan and Panoramic Photo; 2502_P_1050 Revision D - Existing Site / Roof Plan and Proposed Site / Roof Plan; 2502_P_2000 Revision F - Plans as Proposed; 2502_P_2010 Revision E - Elevations as Proposed: Sheet 1 and 2502_P_2020 Revision F – Elevations as Proposed: Sheet 2.
- 3) No development shall take place including demolition, ground works, vegetation clearance until a Habitat Management Monitoring Plan (HMMP) has been submitted to and approved in writing by the local planning authority. The content of the HMMP shall include the following:
 - a) Description and evaluation of features to be managed.
 - b) Ecological trends and constraints on site that might influence management.
 - c) Aims and objectives of management which will (without limitation) include the provision of biodiversity net gain within the Site as shown within the Biodiversity Net Gain Technical Note (AAe Environmental Consultants, September 2025).
 - d) Appropriate management options for achieving aims and objectives.
 - e) Prescriptions for management actions.
 - f) Preparation of a work schedule (including an annual work plan capable of being rolled forward over a thirty-year period).
 - g) Details of the body or organization responsible for implementation of the plan.
 - h) Ongoing monitoring and remedial measures.
 - i) Details of species-specific enhancements proposed within the development including locations and models.

The HMMP shall also include details of the legal and funding mechanism(s) by which the long-term implementation of the plan will be secured by the developer with the management body(ies) responsible for its delivery. The plan shall be for no less than 30 years. The plan shall also set out (where the results from monitoring show that conservation aims and objectives of the HMMP are not being met) how contingencies and/or remedial action will be identified, agreed, and implemented so that the development still delivers the fully functioning biodiversity objectives of the originally approved scheme. The approved plan will be implemented in accordance with the approved details.
- 4) No development shall take place until a detailed schedule of materials to be used on the external elevations of each of the dwellings hereby permitted, including details of source and supplier, shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the local planning authority. The development shall thereafter be completed and retained for the life of the development in accordance with the approved details.

- 5) No development above slab level of the dwelling hereby approved, details of how the scheme will achieve efficiency in the use of natural resources, including measures to minimise energy use, improve water efficiency and promote waste minimisation and recycling shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the local planning authority. The development shall thereafter be carried out and thereafter maintained in accordance with the approved details.
- 6) The residential dwellings forming Units 3 and 4 hereby approved, as shown on drawing number 2502_P_1050, shall be constructed and fitted out to comply with the Building Regulations 2010 (as amended) optional requirement M4(2) 'accessible and adaptable' as a minimum prior to first occupation. Such provision shall be maintained for the lifetime of the development.
- 7) The dwellings hereby permitted shall be built and fitted out so as not to exceed the optional water consumption standard of 110 litres per person per day, as set out in Approved Document G of the Building Regulations 2010 (as amended). Such measures shall be maintained for the lifetime of the development.
- 8) The development hereby permitted, including site clearance, demolition and during the construction phase, shall be implemented in accordance with the recommendations outlined in Section 4.0 of the Preliminary Ecological Appraisal & Phase 2 Bat Survey (AAE Environmental Consultants, September 2025). All mitigation measures shall have been provided prior to first occupation of the development hereby permitted and shall thereafter be retained for the lifetime of the development.
- 9) The development should be carried out in accordance with the measures set out in the Energy Statement contained within the submitted 2502_P_010_Architect's Design, Access, and Energy Statement Rev A_29.09.2025. All measures shall be implemented prior to first occupation of the dwellings hereby permitted and maintained thereafter for the life of the development.
- 10) The scheme for parking and manoeuvring indicated on the approved plans shall be laid out prior to the first occupation of the dwelling to which it relates and that area shall thereafter be retained as such in perpetuity and shall not be used for any other purpose.
- 11) Prior to the first occupation of the dwellings hereby approved, full details of soft landscaping shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority. These details shall include any new trees or hedgerows, as well as those to be retained, showing their species, spread and maturity, planting plans; written specification (including cultivation and other operations associated with plan and grass establishment); schedules of plants; noting species, plant sizes and proposed numbers/densities. The approved soft landscaping shall thereafter be carried out within the first planting season following the first occupation of the development or the completion of the development whichever is the sooner.
- 12) Prior to the first occupation of the dwellings hereby permitted, full details of all hard landscaping and boundary treatments shall be submitted to and approved in writing by the local planning authority. The approved details shall

thereafter be installed prior to the first occupation of the dwelling hereby permitted and shall be retained as such thereafter.

- 13) Prior to the first occupation of the dwellings hereby permitted, the proposed bin store area indicated on approved drawing number 2502_P_2000 Revision F shall be laid out and made available for the storage of bins in association with the new dwellings. The bin storage area shall thereafter be retained as such in perpetuity and shall not be used for another purpose.
- 14) Any tree or shrub which forms part of the approved landscaping which within a period of five years from planting fails to become established, becomes seriously damaged or diseased, dies or for any reason is removed shall be replaced in the next planting season by a tree or shrub of a species, size and maturity similar to the one it replaces.
- 15) Notwithstanding the provisions of Classes A – E inclusive of Part 1 of Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (or any order revoking or re-enacting or amending that order) no enlargement, alteration or improvement of the dwellinghouses hereby approved shall be undertaken, nor shall any outbuildings be erected anywhere within the curtilage of the dwellinghouses hereby approved, at any time without the prior planning permission of the local planning authority.
- 16) Notwithstanding the provisions of Class A of Part 2, Schedule 2 of the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (or any order revoking or re-enacting or amending that order) no gate, fence, wall or other means of enclosure (other than any approved as part of a planning condition) shall be erected, constructed or placed anywhere within the application site or curtilage of the dwellinghouses hereby approved, without the prior planning permission of the local planning authority.

End of conditions